

April 14, 2026

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Assistant Adjunct Professor position at the UC Center Sacramento. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, and my research and teaching interests lie at the intersection of macroeconomics, public policy, and inequality, with a strong emphasis on quantitative methods and policy-relevant analysis.

My research combines structural economic modeling with empirical analysis using micro and panel data. My job market paper develops a heterogeneous-agent model with return heterogeneity to study wealth inequality and the welfare effects of tax policy. I estimate the model using microdata to match observed wealth dynamics and use it to evaluate policy counterfactuals. In complementary work using the Health and Retirement Study, I apply panel data methods and causal identification strategies to study how trust and financial behavior affect household outcomes. Across projects, I focus on translating rigorous quantitative analysis into insights relevant for policy design.

This focus aligns closely with the mission of the UC Center Sacramento. I am particularly excited by the Center's emphasis on connecting academic research with policymakers and students through applied policy work. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to translational research activities, including the development of policy briefs, applied research reports, and student-led projects that engage directly with current policy issues.

In teaching, I have experience leading Principles and Intermediate Macroeconomics courses, and I am comfortable teaching courses in public policy, applied econometrics, and policy analysis. My approach emphasizes building intuition while equipping students with the tools to analyze real-world policy questions using data. I particularly enjoy mentoring students on applied research projects and helping them translate technical analysis into clear, policy-relevant communication.

I am also eager to engage with state and local policy questions, including labor markets, inequality, and public finance, and to incorporate these topics into both teaching and research. The opportunity to work in Sacramento, in close proximity to policymakers, provides an ideal setting for this type of engagement.

Thank you for your consideration. I would be excited to contribute to the UC Center Sacramento's teaching, research, and policy mission.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards